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1. Problem Identification

Students: The Struggle for Targeted Practice

Challenge	**Description**
Targeted Feedback	Students cannot isolate specific areas for improvement immediately for a specific speech context
Schedule & Accountability	Students struggle to always make it to practice sessions, leading to inconsistent progress
Self-Review Aversion	Students avoid listening to their own recorded voice, a crucial step for identifying flaws in delivery and style → they have no structured way to compare a corrected version against their original

Instructors: The Capacity & Focus Gap

Challenge	Description
Limited 24/7 Availability	Coaches cannot be available around the clock for every student
Lack of Before-and-After Focus	Instructors don't get to see a student correct a specific segment of their speech and compare the two versions side-by-side → makes it hard to measure whether a student has truly internalised feedback for that context
Lack of Tools	No standardized tool exists to help students practice specific skills (matter file tests, drills)

2. Market Analysis

Market Overview

Metric	Value
Market Size (2025)	$0.3 billion
Market Size (2034)	$0.6 billion
CAGR	9.2%

Key Market Drivers:

- Digital transformation of education
- Rising demand for critical thinking and communication skills
- Increasing emphasis on soft skills development

Competitive Landscape

Competitor	**Target Audience**	**Key Features**	**Key Gap (Our Opportunity)**
Contra	B2C (Individuals)	AI opponent, real-time streaming, 4-dimension scoring	Consumer-focused; lacks B2B institutional workflow
Counter-Point	B2C (Individuals)	AI opponent, 4 personalities, real-time analysis	Consumer-focused; no B2B integration
DebateMate	B2C (Individuals)	AI opponent, real-time analysis, voice synthesis	Open-source/consumer; lacks institutional structure
DebateGuard	B2C (Individuals)	AI opponent, body language analysis	Over-indexes on individual performance
Kialo & Debate.org	B2C/B2B (General)	Argument mapping, community debate	Generic tool
Arete	**B2B + B2C (Academies, Schools, Individuals)**	**Instructor dashboards, structured practice, feedback, style matching, before-and-after correction workflow**	**First-mover advantage in debate-specific EdTech with a dual-user model**

3. Societal Benefit & Significance

Benefit	**Description**
Soft Skills Development	Enhances analytical reasoning, effective communication, and collaborative problem-solving which are skills cited as critical for future success
Civic Engagement	Prepares students to become effective and engaged citizens capable of reasoned discourse

4. Problem Statement & Justification

Problem Statement

Despite the growing demand for debate skills and the emergence of various debate practice tools, there is no dedicated platform that enables debate academies, schools, and coaches to provide their students with structured, data-driven, and efficient practice. Instructors also lack a clear view of student corrections and before-and-after improvement. Current solutions are either consumer-focused, lack the necessary features for institutional use, or fail to integrate with existing academy workflow.

Problem Justification

Factor	**Evidence**
Market Validation	Strong interest from academies (tested with a Capstone pilot) demonstrates clear demand for this solution
Market Potential	Market projected to reach $0.6 billion by 2034, a significant and growing opportunity
Technological Feasibility	Recent AI advancements enable real-time analysis and personalized feedback
B2B Advantage	Sustainable, scalable revenue; lower CAC; deeper workflow integration; high knowledge barriers to entry

5. Customer Discovery

Minimum Viable Segment (MVS) / Beachhead Market

Our beachhead market is Hong Kong debate academies and secondary schools, with an initial focus on Capstone as our launch partner.

Factor	**Rationale**
Proven Demand	Capstone has demonstrated demand by piloting a "dropbox" form solution

Factor	Rationale
High Density	Hong Kong has a highly competitive debate ecosystem with well-funded academies
Strategic Foothold	Success with Capstone provides powerful social proof for expanding to the broader market
Talent Pipeline	Continuous user feedback from both coaches and students

Expansion Strategy: Hong Kong (Beachhead) → Singapore & Australia (Regional) → North America & Europe (Global)

Interview & Data Collection

Phase	Activity
Outreach	Leverage Capstone partnership; use MVP demo screenshots Secure executive buy-in; gain permission to interview coaches and students
Pain Point Validation	Semi-structured interviews with decision-makers, coaches, and students
Solution Interest	Demo MVP screenshots; test willingness to pay
Integration	Understand workflow fit

Key Deliverables:

- Validated Problem-Solution Fit
- Prioritized Feature Backlog
- Integration Roadmap
- Data-driven Pricing Model

6. Solution - see Overview

7. Competitive Advantage

Advantage	**Description**	**Impact**
Localised	Deep understanding of Hong Kong debate ecosystem and WSDC/BP formats → trained on local competition data and judging criteria	Ensures feedback and practice scenarios are directly relevant to competitions students enter
Specialised	Built exclusively for debate education → instructor dashboards, class management, and before-and-after correction workflows	Purpose-built tool that fits seamlessly into academy workflow
Personalised	Targeted feedback on individual student's strengths and gaps → "speech correction" workflow and style matching enable personalized coaching at scale	Students get clear, actionable "one thing to work on", accelerating improvement

Quality Comparison: Our AI vs. Generic LLM

Feature	**Generic LLM (eg, ChatGPT)**	**Arete**
Training Data	General internet text	Curated dataset of WSDC/BP winning speeches, judge feedback, motion analysis
Output Relevance	Generic, often vague advice	Specific, actionable feedback on matter, manner, and method
Contextual Awareness	Unaware of competition formats or judging trends	Tuned to WSDC/BP and local judging preferences

Feature	Generic LLM (eg, ChatGPT)	Arete
Accuracy	Can hallucinate or provide incorrect debate terminology	High accuracy in identifying logical fallacies, argument structures, and strategic gaps
Integration	Standalone tool, requiring manual copy-pasting	Fully integrated into practice workflow with instructor dashboards and progress tracking

8. Unique Value Proposition (UVP)

For Instructors and Businesses (The "Why Buy")

> "Your students need help outside class hours—but you can't be available 24/7 for every student. Our platform gives you a clear window into every correction your students submit, with before-and-after playback so you can see exactly how they've improved. Focus your limited time on the students who need you most, and prove their progress to parents and stakeholders."

For Students (The "Why Use")

> "Stop guessing what to improve. Our platform gives you one clear, actionable focus area for every practice session. With style matching, targeted drills, and the ability to correct and see your improvement, you'll build confidence and skills faster than ever before."

9. Blue Ocean Strategy

Competitive Factor	Red Ocean	Blue Ocean
Target Customer	B2C (Individual students)	B2B (Academies, schools) + B2C (Individual subscribers)
Primary Use Case	Solo practice with AI opponent	Instructor-led practice management + self-directed improvement

Competitive Factor	Red Ocean	Blue Ocean
Value Delivery	Generic feedback from AI	Targeted feedback with before-and-after correction visibility
Success Metric	Individual skill improvement	Institutional student retention + measurable correction-based progress
Integration	Standalone tool	Seamless integration into academy workflow and curriculum
Revenue Model	Individual subscriptions	Institutional licensing + individual subscriptions (dual-tier)

10. Minimum Viable Product (MVP) - see MVP prompt

11. A/B Testing

Testing Philosophy

1. Data-Driven Decision Making: All significant changes validated through controlled experiments
2. Continuous Improvement: Testing is an ongoing process integrated into the development lifecycle
3. User-Centric Optimization: Every test designed to improve user experience and learning outcomes

Testing Infrastructure

Tool Category	Example Tools	Purpose
Analytics & Tracking	Mixpanel, Amplitude	Track user behavior, engagement, and conversion funnels
Statistical Analysis	Optimizely, VWO	Analyze results and determine statistical significance

A/B Testing Roadmap

Priority 1: Onboarding & Activation ~4 weeks

Test	Variants	Success Metric
Onboarding Flow	A: Tutorial video; B: Interactive walkthrough	Feature adoption rate, time to first action
First Speech Prompt	A: Random motion; B: Recommended motion; C: Free choice	First speech completion rate
Initial Feedback Presentation	A: Text-only; B: Gamified with badges/visuals	User satisfaction, return rate

Priority 2: Feature Optimization ~8 weeks

Test	Variants	Success Metric
Practice Mode Selection	A: Single mode; B: "Practice" vs "Competition"	Session duration, frequency of mode selection
Matter Test Frequency	A: Weekly; B: Bi-weekly; C: On-demand	Test completion rate, overall engagement
Drill Recommendations	A: Generic list; B: Personalized recommendations	Drill adoption rate, improvement in feedback scores
"Before & After" Playback	A: Sequential; B: Side-by-side; C: Interactive slider	User engagement, perceived value

Priority 3: Gamification ~8 weeks

Test	Variants	Success Metric
Leaderboard Format	A: Identifiable; B: Anonymized with avatars; C: Team-based	Test completion rate, retention
Streak Tracking	A: No streak; B: Visual indicators; C: Rewards	DAU, 30-day retention

Test	Variants	Success Metric
Feedback Presentation	A: Comprehensive report; B: Segmented with focus areas	NPS, repeat usage
Push Notification Timing	A: Morning; B: Evening; C: Triggered	Open rate, conversion to action

Priority 4: Instructor Tools ~6 weeks

Test	Variants	Success Metric
Dashboard Layout	A: Standard list; B: "Needs review" alerts	Instructor login frequency, comments made
Before-and-After Presentation	A: Side-by-side; B: Sequential; C: Highlight-changes	Instructor satisfaction, perceived value
Student Progress Reports	A: No reports; B: PDF generation	Feature adoption, renewal intent

12. Key Stats

Key Metrics	Target
Monthly Active Users	5,000+ (Year 1 target)
Student Retention Rate	70%+ month-over-month
Practice Sessions per Student	4+ per week
Instructor Adoption Rate	90%+ of partner academy coaches
NPS	+50 (students), +60 (instructors)
ARR	$500K+ (Year 3 target)

Cost Structure	Revenue Streams
Development & Maintenance: AI/LLM API costs, frontend/backend engineering	**B2B Organisation Subscription:** Tiered pricing based on number of students/teams. Businesses pay a lot more
Marketing & Sales: Outreach to academies, schools, and individual users	
Support: Customer success for institutional clients	**B2C Individual Subscription:** Small monthly fee for solo users
Infrastructure: Cloud hosting and storage	**Free Trial:** First week free for any organisation or individual, then pay —> during signup, an individual registers either alone or under an organisation (if under an organisation, they are part of that team/institutional billing)

13. Go-to-Market Strategy

Core Principles

1. **Relationship-First Sales:** Prioritize warm introductions and personal connections
2. **Proof of Value:** Capstone pilot serves as case study
3. **Community-Led Growth:** Embed in debate community (JSDC, regional circuits, WSDC networks)
4. **Dual-Tier B2B + B2C Model:** Institutional licensing provides predictable recurring revenue; individual subscriptions capture the long tail

Pricing & Subscription Model (Revised)

Tier	Target Customer	Pricing Model	Free Trial
B2B – Organisation	Debate academies, schools, clubs	**Monthly Subscription** ($99.99/20 students)	First week free for the whole organisation
B2C – Individual	Solo debaters not affiliated with an organisation	**Small monthly subscription fee** ($4.99/month)	First week free
Signup Flow	During registration, the user chooses: "I	If part of an organisation, they	N/A

Tier	Target Customer	Pricing Model	Free Trial
	am part of an organisation" or "I am registering alone"	join that team and are billed under the organisation's plan → need to implement organisation-specific codes for onboarding	

Phased Go-to-Market Execution

Hong Kong - Beachhead Market

Activity	Method	Target
Capstone Pilot	Personal connection with Capstone leadership	Validate product, secure case study
Product Iteration	Develop Version 1.0 based on feedback	Product ready for wider release
HK Debate Academies	Leverage Hong Kong debate circuit connections	5-10 additional partners
HK Schools	JSDC community engagement, presentations at events	10-15 secondary schools
Cold-Emailing	Personalized cold emails to debate program directors	Generate leads and schedule demos

Regional Expansion - Southeast Asia

Activity	Method	Target
Malaysia	Outreach to debate academies and top-tier schools	3-5 partners
Singapore	Outreach to debate academies and elite schools	3-5 partners

Activity	Method	Target
Thailand, Philippines, Indonesia	Cold-emailing and regional partnerships	2-3 partners each
Regional Tournaments	Attend/Sponsor	Brand awareness, decision-maker networking
Localization	Adapt motion banks and style matching for regional preferences	Increased relevance and adoption

International Expansion - WSDC Countries

Activity	Method	Target
Australia	Outreach to debate academies and top schools	3-5 partners
UK	Outreach to debate organizations, schools, universities	3-5 partners
Canada	Outreach to debate academies and high schools	2-3 partners
USA	Outreach to WSDC-participating schools and academies	2-3 partners
WSDC National Bodies	Partner with national debate bodies	5+ national bodies
Global Marketing	SEO, content marketing, paid ads targeting global keywords	Global brand awareness and lead generation
Format Expansion	Add support for BP, AP, LD, Policy, Public Forum	Expanded market reach
Language Expansion	Add multilingual support (Mandarin, Malay, Tagalog)	Expanded market reach

Sales & Outreach Strategy

Channel	Description	Target Audience
Warm Introduction	Leverage existing connections (Capstone, JSDC, debate circuit)	Capstone, HK debate academies, JSDC contacts
Cold-Emailing	Personalized and value-driven cold emails to decision-makers	Debate academies, schools with debate programs
Community Engagement	Active participation in debate community events	Coaches, students, debate organizers
Digital Marketing	Targeted LinkedIn/Facebook ads, SEO content, email newsletters	Educators, program directors, school administrators
Referral Program	Incentivize existing partners to refer to other institutions	Current partners and clients
Partnerships	Strategic partnerships with debate organizations	National debate bodies, educational associations

Cold-Emailing Template

Subject: Transform your debate practice with AI-powered targeted feedback

Dear [Name],

I hope this email finds you well.

I'm reaching out because I've been following the incredible work [Academy/School Name] has been doing in the debate community. Your students' success in [mention recent achievement] is truly impressive.

I'm writing to share a new tool we've developed specifically for debate academies and schools like yours. Our platform helps students practice more effectively by providing:

- **Targeted, AI-powered feedback** on every speech (Matter and Manner)
- **"Before and after" playback** so students can hear and correct their own speeches—and instructors can see the improvement
- **Gamified matter file tests** with leaderboards to drive content mastery
- **Skill-specific drills** for focused improvement

- **Instructor dashboards** to see every correction submission and comment directly

Our platform is designed to complement your coaching—giving you a clear window into student progress outside class hours, without adding to your workload.

We're offering a **free one-week trial** for your organisation. I'd love to schedule a 15-minute demo to show you our screenshots and discuss how we might support your students' success.

Are you available for a quick call next week?

Best regards,

[Your Name] [Your Title] [Your Contact Information]

14. Branding

Tangible Brand Elements

Logo Concept: "The Voice Bubble"

1. **Speech Bubble:** Dialogue, argumentation, spoken word
2. **Debate Podium/Pillar:** Structure, competition, elevation
3. **AI Circuitry:** Subtle representation of AI-powered intelligence

Color Palette

Color	Hex Code	Usage	Psychology
Blue	#2563EB	Primary buttons, headings	Trust, intelligence, confidence
Blue	#3B82F6	Secondary UI elements	Stability, reliability
Orange	#F97316	CTAs, notifications	Energy, action, engagement
Purple	#8B5CF6	Premium features	Creativity, premium quality
Green	#22C55E	Positive feedback	Growth, success
Red	#EF4444	Areas for improvement	Urgency, correction

Typography

Font	Usage	Characteristics
Brand Name	Custom bubble letters	Playful, approachable, memorable
Headings & Body	Inter (Sans-serif)	Modern, clean, highly readable
Accent/Display	Outfit (Sans-serif)	Friendly, rounded, complementary
Monospace	JetBrains Mono	Code snippets, technical elements

Tagline

Primary: "Find Your Voice. Sharpen Your Argument."

Secondary:

- "AI-Powered Debate Practice for Academies and Schools." (B2B)
- "Practice Smarter. Debate Better." (Student-focused)
- "Your Personal Debate Coach, Powered by AI." (Product-focused)
- "From Practice to Podium." (Aspirational)
- "One Platform. Infinite Improvement." (Brand-focused)

Intangible Brand Elements

Brand Story: From Student Debater to Founder

> "I was a student debater once. Nervous, passionate, and desperate to improve. I spent hours at home, consolidating my own case files, practicing speeches in front of my phone camera and trying to rewatch at least the first minute, and begging for systemic and concrete feedback. But something was always missing.
>
> I couldn't isolate my weaknesses. I couldn't hear my own voice objectively. I couldn't practice consistently because life—exams, assignments, extracurricular commitments—always got in the way.
>
> And when I did get coaching, my instructors couldn't be there 24/7. I wished I had a way to practice on my own, get feedback, correct myself, and show my coach exactly what I had improved.
>
> I realized I could build the tool I had always needed. A tool that would give students targeted, actionable feedback. A tool that would let them correct

specific segments and compare before and after. A tool that would make self-review less painful and more productive.

I built this platform for me. And for every other student who dreams of standing on that podium, finding their voice, and winning more than just the round."

Brand Values

Value	**Description**
Empowerment	Every student has a voice worth hearing, we give them the tools to sharpen it
Excellence	Committed to the highest standards of debate training
Accessibility	Elite debate training should not be reserved for the privileged few
Innovation	Embrace AI to augment human coaching, not replace it
Community	Debate is a community sport → connection, competition, and collaboration
Authenticity	Built by debaters, for debaters

Brand Voice

Attribute	**Description**
Encouraging	Speak like a supportive coach—firm but kind, constructive not critical
Clear	Avoid jargon; explain complex concepts simply
Professional	Maintain credibility and authority, especially in B2B communications
Playful	Embrace the energy and enthusiasm of youth debate culture
Empathetic	Understand the struggles of student debaters because we've been there

Brand Personality: The "Supportive Coach" Archetype

Trait	Description
Knowledgeable	Know debate inside and out → AI trained on winning speeches
Encouraging	Celebrate every improvement → progress, not perfection.
Approachable	Friendly, accessible, and easy to talk to
Reliable	Deliver consistent, high-quality feedback
Innovative	Always exploring new ways to help students improve
Community-Focused	Debate is better together

15. Scaling Strategy

PMF Assessment

Dimension	Metric	Target
User Engagement	Monthly Active Users	>80% of total users
Retention	30-Day Retention Rate	>70%
Satisfaction	NPS	>+50 (students), >+60 (instructors)
Willingness to Pay	Free-to-Paid Conversion Rate	>30%
Referral	Organic Referral Rate	>20%
Usage Depth	Feature Adoption Rate	>60% use core features
Institutional Value	Partner Renewal Rate	>90%

Key Financial Metrics for Scaling

Metric	Definition	Year 1 Target	Year 2 Target	Year 3 Target
ARR	Annualized value of all active subscriptions	$10,000	$30,000	$100,000
Churn Rate	Percentage of customers who do not renew	<10%	<10%	<12%
Gross Margin	Revenue remaining after costs	>70%	>72%	>75%

Horizontal Expansion Strategy

Region	Target Customers	Key Activities
Hong Kong	Debate academies, secondary schools	Capstone pilot, JSDC engagement, cold-emailing
SEA (Malaysia, Singapore, Thailand, Philippines, Indonesia)	Debate academies, international schools, elite schools	Regional partnerships, cold-emailing, tournament attendance, localized content
Australia, UK, Canada, USA, WSDC countries	National debate bodies, debate academies, universities, high schools	International partnerships, digital marketing, global content strategy, multilingual support

Debate Format Expansion

Format	Status
WSDC	Core focus, currently supported
BP	Current focus, expanding AI feedback for BP
Asian Parliamentary	Future expansion
LD, Policy, Public Forum	Future expansion for US markets

Language Expansion

Language	Status	Timeline
English	Core + Fully supported	Current
Chinese	Current focus + Style matching for HKT-specific delivery	Months 6-12
Malay, Tagalog	Future expansion	Months 18-24

16. Financials

Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Description	Status
B2B Organisation Subscription (Primary)	Annual fixed-fee subscriptions based on student count	Active pilot phase
B2C Individual Subscription	Small monthly fee (e.g., $4.99/month) for solo users	Future
Free Trial	First week free for any organisation or individual	At launch
Signup Flow	Users register as "part of an organisation" (joins team → institutional billing) or "alone" (individual subscription)	At launch

Break-Even Analysis

Metric	Value
Fixed Costs (Annual)	Minimal (development, marketing, support)
Variable Cost Per B2B Client	$100 (AI processing, storage, support annually)

Metric	Value
Average Revenue Per B2B Client	$3,000

17. Elevator Pitch

Customer Pitch (B2B - Decision Makers)

"Imagine if every student in your academy could practice anytime, anywhere, and receive specific, actionable feedback—and you could see exactly how they've improved on each correction, without adding to your coaches' workload.

Our platform gives your students an AI-powered debate coach that analyzes their speeches, provides before-and-after playback, and tracks corrections. For you, we provide an instructor dashboard that shows every correction submission with side-by-side comparison, so your coaches can focus their limited time on the students who need them most.

We're offering a free one-week trial for your organisation. We'd love to show you our demo and discuss how we can help your students improve faster."

Student Pitch (End-User)

"Ever finished a practice speech and thought, 'I have no idea what to work on'? Or dreaded listening to your own recording because it's awkward and uncomfortable?

We built a tool for you. Record your speech, and our AI gives you instant feedback on exactly what to improve—one clear, actionable thing to focus on. Then correct that segment, hear the before and after side-by-side, and submit it to your coach. Practice specific skills with targeted drills. Compete with your friends on matter file leaderboards.

It's like having a personal debate coach in your pocket. No more guessing. Just smarter practice, faster improvement."